

# KENTARO NAKAMURA

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Website: <https://k-nakam.github.io>

## EDUCATION

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### Harvard University

Ph.D. | *Public Policy* (Politics and Institution Track)

- Affiliation: Institute of Quantitative Social Science (IQSS)

Sep.2023 – Present

Cambridge, USA

### University of Chicago

Master of Science | *Statistics*

Sep.2021 – Jun.2023

Chicago, USA

### Waseda University

Bachelor of Arts | *Major: Political Science, Minor: Law, Certificate: Data Science*

- Best Paper Award (Excellent work at the Category of Mathematical and Statistical Measurement)

Apr.2017 – Sep.2021

Tokyo, Japan

### George Washington University

Exchange Program

Aug.2019 – May.2020

Washington D.C., USA

## RESEARCH INTEREST

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Causal Inference with Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Political Communication, Political Violence

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

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### Leveraging Generative Artificial Intelligence for Causal Inference with Unstructured Data

*Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, with Kosuke Imai [\[URL\]](#)

- Proposed a new framework to use the internal representations of deep generative models for statistical inference

### Causal Inference with Generative Artificial Intelligence: Application to Texts as Treatments

*Journal of the American Statistical Association*, with Kosuke Imai [\[URL\]](#)

- Developed new experimental designs to use texts created by deep generative model as a treatment

### Understanding the Impact of Military Service on Support for Insurrection in the United States

*Journal of Conflict Resolution*, with Robert Pape, Keven Ruby, and Kyle Larson [\[URL\]](#)

- Analyzed why and how civilians with prior military experiences are prone to support political violence.

### Balancing Opportunities and Incentives: How Rising China's Mediated Public Diplomacy Changes under Crisis

*International Journal of Communication* [\[URL\]](#)

- Estimated the strategic shift of the rising China's public diplomacy under crisis by machine learning

## SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

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### Surrogate Representation Inference for Text and Image Annotations

*Under Review* [\[URL\]](#)

- Proposed a framework to improve efficiency with noisy and partially observed annotations
- Best poster award at the 2025 Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology.

### Observational Equivalence of LLM and Human Annotation

*Under Review*, with Jing Ling Tan and George Yean [\[URL\]](#)

- Evaluated the quality of LLM annotations compared to human annotations.

### GenAI Powered Dynamic Causal Inference with Unstructured Data

*Under Review*, with Kosuke Imai [\[URL\]](#)

- Proposed a framework to intervene the unstructured data at more granular level (e.g., sentences).

### Where's the Evidence that Respondents Understand Your Survey Questions?

*Working Paper*, with Musashi Hinck, Gary King, and Brandon Stewart [\[URL\]](#)

- Proposed a framework and methodology to assess survey question understanding.

### Causal Inference with Video Features as Treatments

*Working Paper*, with Adam Breuer, Michael H. Crespin, Bryce J. Dietrich, Kosuke Imai [\[URL\]](#)

- Proposed a framework for causal inference with video features as treatments.

## INVITAED TALKS / PRESENTATIONS

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**Frontier in Political Methodology**, Washington University in St. Louis (2026) [\[URL\]](#)

**Stanford University**, Guest Speaker for POLISCI 450D (2026)

**Causal Inference Showcase**, Harvard University (2026). [\[URL\]](#)

**Nospare** (Webinar for public audiences) (2025) [\[URL\]](#)

## SOFTWARE

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**Debriefly** [\[URL\]](#)

Survey Software for Automated Cognitive Debriefing

**gpi-pack** [\[URL\]](#)

Python module for Generative-AI Powered Inference.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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**Research Assistant for Prof. Gary King**

Harvard University

May.2024 – Present

Cambridge, USA

- Worked on the project of the automated cognitive debriefing (co-author)

**Research Assistant for Prof. Matthew Baum**

Shorenstein Center, Harvard Kennedy School

Nov.2023 – Present

Cambridge, USA

**Data and Causal Inference Analyst**

Chicago Projects on Security and Threats (CPOST), University of Chicago

Sep.2022 – Aug.2023

Chicago, USA

- Designed experiments, discussed identification strategies, and implemented causal mediation analysis

**Research Assistant for Prof. Shuhei Kurizaki**

Waseda University

May.2020 – Sep.2021

Tokyo, Japan

- Conducted the qualitative research on the foreign takeover in Europe (Co-Author since September 2020)

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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**Teaching Fellow: GOV2003 (Causal Inference with Applications)**

Harvard University

Fall 2026

Cambridge, USA

- Offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai

**Teaching Fellow: GOV2003 (Statistical Models for Quantitative Social Science)**

Harvard University

Spring 2026

Cambridge, USA

- Offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai (Evaluation: 5.0 / 5.0) [\[Evaluation\]](#)

**Teaching Fellow: GOV2002 (Causal Inference with Applications)**

Harvard University

Fall 2025

Cambridge, USA

- Offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai (Evaluation: 4.67 / 5.0) [\[Evaluation\]](#)

**Teaching Assistant at the Center for Data Science**

Waseda University

Sep.2020 – Mar.2021

Tokyo, Japan

- Checked class materials and answered the questions about Statistics and Machine Learning

## HONORS AND AWARDS

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Center for American Political Studies (CAPS) Seed Grant</b><br>Research Grant for Dissertation Research (USD1,000)                                                                     | Apr.2026              |
| <b>Society of Political Methodology Best Poster Award</b><br>Best Method Poster presented by graduate students at PolMeth2025 (Emory) <a href="#">[News]</a>                              | Jul.2025              |
| <b>The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grant</b><br>Research Grant for Dissertation Research (USD2,000)                                                         | Apr.2025              |
| <b>The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grant</b><br>Research Grant for the joint project with Jing Ling Tan and George Yang (USD2,000)                          | Apr.2025              |
| <b>Harvard Kennedy School Travel Grant</b><br>Travel Grant for attending JSQPS2025 Winter Meeting (USD1000)                                                                               | Jan.2025              |
| <b>The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Travel Grant</b><br>Travel Grant for attending PolMeth2024 (USD500)                                                               | Jul.2024              |
| <b>Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship</b><br>Merit-based scholarship. Partial tuition coverage (JPY 3 million yen) and monthly stipends.                                   | Sep.2023 - Aug.2026   |
| <b>Graduate Council Research &amp; Personal Development Fund, University of Chicago</b><br>Travel Grant for attending SPSA2023 (USD600)                                                   | Jan. 2023             |
| <b>Tuition Fellowship, University of Chicago</b><br>Equivalent to 25 percent of my approved tuition. Increased to 30% from 2nd year                                                       | Sep. 2021 - Jun. 2023 |
| <b>Statistics Consulting Cup Awards</b><br>Best Prize in the Consulting Program at the Department of Statistics. <a href="#">[News]</a>                                                   | Dec.2021              |
| <b>NSK Ltd. Scholarship</b><br>Scholarship provided only for top four students in Japan. JPY13,600,000 $\approx$ USD100,000                                                               | Sep.2021 – Jun.2023   |
| <b>Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship</b><br>Declined to accept NSK Scholarship. Merit-based scholarship.                                                                  | Mar.2021              |
| <b>Best Paper Award (Category of Mathematical and Statistical Measurement)</b><br>Thesis Competition of the Waseda Association for Political Science and Economics <a href="#">[News]</a> | Feb.2021              |
| <b>Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship</b><br>Merit based scholarship to support exchange program. JPY900,000. $\approx$ USD7,000                                           | Aug.2019 – May.2020   |

## ACADEMIC SERVICES / DISCUSSANT ROLES

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**Discussant:** SPSA (2023), APSA (2025)  
**Reviewer:** Political Analysis (2), International Studies Quarterly, Journal of Applied Econometrics  
**Others:** Coordinator of Applied Statistics Workshop, Harvard University (2025-2026)

## SKILLS

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**Languages:** Japanese (Native), English (Fluent), Spanish (B1; Intermediate)  
**Programming:** (Proficient) Python(3.X), R, C++ (Rcpp),  $\LaTeX$ , ArcGIS, STATA, HTML / (Experience) C, SQL

## REFERENCES

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Available upon request

*Last updated on September 7, 2026*